

Front-Desk Master SOP: The TWMM Intake Framework

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Introduction

This **Front-Desk Master SOP (Standard Operating Procedure)** is designed to serve as the "Operational Gateway" for your clinic's revenue cycle. By standardizing these intake protocols, your practice can achieve a high clean-claim rate and eliminate the most common "front-end" causes of reimbursement delays.

1. Real-Time Eligibility (RTE) Verification

- **Explanation:** This is the process of electronically verifying a patient's insurance coverage, co-pay, and deductible status at the point of service.
- **Importance:** Insurance status changes frequently; verifying eligibility *before* the patient sees the provider prevents "uncovered service" denials that are often uncollectible.
- **Why Included:** Eligibility errors are the #1 cause of claim rejections in 1–20 provider practices.
- **Evaluation (Manual):**
 1. **Protocol:** Run RTE 48 hours before the appointment and again at check-in.
 2. **Verification:** Confirm "Active" status and identify if a Prior Authorization is required for the visit type.
- **Record:** Document the Eligibility Reference Number in the EMR's insurance verification field.

2. Patient Identity & Demographic Governance

- **Explanation:** Ensuring the patient's name, date of birth, and social security number exactly match their insurance record and photo ID.
- **Importance:** Even a minor typo in a patient's name (e.g., "Jon" vs. "Jonathan") can trigger an "Individual Not Found" denial.
- **Why Included:** Accurate demographics are the foundation of a clean claim; data integrity at intake reduces downstream administrative rework.
- **Evaluation (Manual):**
 1. **Comparison:** Physically inspect the photo ID and insurance card at every visit.
 2. **Audit:** Review 10 random charts per month to cross-reference ID scans with EMR data entry.
- **Record:** Note the date of the last demographic update in the patient's header.

3. Co-Pay & Outstanding Balance Collection

- **Explanation:** The mandatory collection of patient financial responsibilities at the time of check-in.
- **Importance:** The likelihood of collecting patient-owed balances drops by 50% once the patient leaves the office.
- **Why Included:** Healthy cash flow requires capturing small balances consistently to reduce the cost of mailing monthly statements.
- **Evaluation (Manual):**
 1. **Target:** Aim for a **100% Co-pay Collection Rate** for all seen patients.
 2. **Reconciliation:** Compare the daily schedule against the "Point of Sale" (POS) merchant report.
- **Record:** Log daily collection totals and flag any "exceptions" where a co-pay was waived or deferred.

4. Prior Authorization (PA) Management

- **Explanation:** Confirming that the payer has approved the specific service or procedure before it is performed.
- **Importance:** Performing a procedure without a required PA results in an automatic "Hard Denial" that is nearly impossible to appeal.

- **Why Included:** PAs are increasingly required for routine imaging and specialty visits; this SOP ensures your clinic doesn't provide free care.
- **Evaluation (Manual):**
 1. **Checklist:** Reference your "Top Payer PA List" for all scheduled appointments.
 2. **Verification:** Ensure the PA number is on the encounter form before the patient is called back.
- **Record:** Maintain a "Pending PA" log to follow up on outstanding requests daily.

5. Notice of Privacy Practices (NPP) & Consent Compliance

- **Explanation:** Obtaining and documenting the patient's acknowledgement of their privacy rights and consent for treatment.
 - **Importance:** Missing or expired consents are a high-risk HIPAA violation and can lead to legal liability.
 - **Why Included:** This is a core requirement of our **Assess. Fix. Govern.** model to ensure audit readiness.
 - **Evaluation (Manual):**
 1. **Review:** Check the "Consent Date" field in the EMR during check-in.
 2. **Update:** Ensure consents are renewed annually or whenever the NPP is updated.
 - **Record:** Scan signed documents into the EMR and flag the record as "Compliant".
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How TWMM Can Help You

Transworld Medical Management specializes in bridging the gap between front-office operations and back-end financial performance.

- **Custom SOP Implementation:** We don't just provide the template; we train your staff in Palm Harbor and the Tampa Bay area on these specific governance protocols.
- **Real-Time Performance Tracking:** We use PowerBI to create "Front-Desk Dashboards" that show you exactly which staff members are hitting their co-pay and eligibility targets.
- **Workflow Remediation:** If your denial rate is high, we perform the Fix by re-engineering these intake steps to stop errors before they reach your billing company.

Ready to move from Assess to Fix? Contact us at admin@transworldmm.com or visit transworldmm.com to schedule your comprehensive Practice Health Assessment.